



Your application, guided by someone who **has been there.**

Thank you for reaching out. This guide walks you through who we are, what we offer, and how to get started so you can make the most of the support you have asked for.

Real guidance. Shared journeys.

We built TAL because we needed it and it did not exist.

The Application Lab was founded in 2025 by people who went through competitive international applications with almost no support. It was not just the paperwork. The confusion about what selectors actually want, the hours spent second guessing yourself, the feeling that everyone else somehow knew something you did not. We wanted to build something we wished had existed when we were applying.

"The problem is not that students lack ability. It is that the right guidance has never reached the right people. We are trying to change that, one application at a time."

THE FOUNDERS, CAMBRIDGE 2025

Two people who applied with almost no support, and built the guide they wished they'd had.

People who have walked this path themselves.



Dr Kanupriya Sharma
CO-FOUNDER

PhD & MPhil in Criminology at Cambridge as a Gates Cambridge Scholar. Nigel Walker Prize (2026). Postdoctoral research fellow on a Leverhulme-funded project at Nottingham, endorsed under the UK Global Talent Visa (UKRI Route 3).

Gates Cambridge Scholar

PhD Cambridge

Nigel Walker Prize 2026

UK Global Talent



Vishal Narula
CO-FOUNDER

MPhil in Engineering for Sustainable Development at Cambridge as a GREAT Cambridge and Cambridge Trust Scholar. Shortlisted for Chevening and the Commonwealth Shared Scholarship. Recognised as a UK Tech Nation Global Talent.

GREAT Cambridge Scholar

MPhil Cambridge

UK Tech Nation Talent

Results our mentees can point to.

£2m+

in scholarships secured, and counting

150+

mentors globally

3,000+

applicants supported

94%

success rate for 1:1 mentorship

OUR MENTEES HAVE WON PLACES AND FUNDING THROUGH

- Chevening
- Commonwealth Scholarships
- Gates Cambridge
- Mastercard Foundation
- Erasmus Mundus

AND GONE ON TO STUDY AT

- Cambridge
- Oxford
- King's College London
- UCL
- Edinburgh
- LSE
- Toronto
- Melbourne
- NUS
- Stanford
- SciencesPo
- NYU

Simple, personal, and no guesswork.

From your first enquiry to your initial session, the process is designed to be seamless and efficient. Here is what you can expect.

01

We look at your interest form

Based on your target programme or scholarship, your timeline, and what you need most help with, we figure out the right package and mentor for where you are right now.

02

We match you with a mentor

We match you with a mentor who has been through the exact application you are preparing for — often the same scholarship, the same institutions.

03

Two free calls first

Before any session begins, you will have a 20-minute discovery call with our team, then a 20-minute introduction call with your matched mentor. Only once you are comfortable do we move forward.

04

Your sessions, on your schedule

Sessions are 60 minutes, conducted online, and arranged directly with your mentor. How you use each session is entirely up to you.

Free mentorship isn't always sustainable. Expensive mentorship isn't always accessible.

TAL is designed to provide mentorship that is affordable, dependable and delivered by mentors who have walked the path — a modest fee creates commitment, mentors stay engaged, and support costs a fraction of traditional consultancies.

	Free Communities	Traditional Consultancies	Premium Consultancies	TAL
Cost	Free	Moderate	High (above £1,000)	Affordable (£54.99/hr)
Personalisation	Inconsistent	Limited	High	High
Mentors	Volunteer-based	Consultants	Professional consultants	Peers who've achieved the same outcome
Incentives	Volunteer availability	Often commission-driven	Client fees	Student outcomes
Continuity	Can be inconsistent	Transactional	High	End-to-end support
Technology	Limited	Limited	Limited	AI-powered platform + community + mentors

SERVICE 01

Lab Focus — one to one live sessions with a mentor who has navigated your exact application

Each session is a 60 minute conversation with a mentor matched to your application. There are no set formats and no fixed agendas — you decide what you need from each session. Prefer it in writing? You can convert any single session into a written document review instead, as long as it is completed within 60 minutes.

Package	Price	Save	Best for	Valid for
1 session	£54.99	—	One specific thing to work through right now	30 days
2 sessions	£104.99	4.54%	A draft plus a follow-up round of feedback	60 days
4 sessions ★ Most popular	£199.99	9.08%	Strategy, two rounds of feedback, and interview prep	120 days
6 sessions	£289.99	12.11%	Thorough support from the beginning	180 days
10 sessions	£469.99	14.53%	Multiple applications running at once	12 months

Please note: session validity periods are strictly observed. Sessions not used within the validity window are forfeited — choose a package that matches your actual timeline.

SERVICE 02

Document Review — detailed written feedback with no live session required

Once you submit your documents, they are reviewed by a mentor who has gone through the same process. Within 7 working days you receive detailed, thoughtful feedback and clear direction on how to strengthen your next draft.

CV and Statement of Purpose or Personal Essay

£49.99

Both documents reviewed together — structure, content, and how well they speak to your target programme.

Returned within 7 working days

SCHOLARSHIP, WRITING SAMPLE AND RESEARCH PROPOSAL REVIEW

For major scholarship applications, your reviewer brings first-hand experience of the award itself — a nuanced understanding of selection criteria and common pitfalls.

Chevening

Gates Cambridge

Commonwealth

Rhodes

Fulbright & Fulbright Nehru

Inlaks Foundation

Erasmus Mundus

Weidenfeld Hoffmann

Mastercard Foundation

University scholarships

PhD research proposal

Writing sample

Pricing depends on the scholarship and the number of essays involved.

Write to us at info@theapplicationlab.com with the name of your scholarship, and we will confirm the cost.

What you can expect from every TAL mentor.

1

They have been where you are

Our mentors have navigated similar applications, often to the same scholarships and institutions, with journeys that closely reflect your own.

2

Honest, not just encouraging

TAL mentors will tell you what actually needs to change, not just what sounds good. The most useful feedback is not always the most comfortable.

3

Reliable and responsive

Sessions are booked directly with your mentor. Document reviews come back within 7 working days. If something does not work, we sort it out.

4

We stay with you after your offer

Once you secure your place, you join the TAL peer and alumni network — and we hope you'll return as a mentor one day.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Ready to get started?

Book a free discovery call and we will confirm your mentor match. It only takes 20 minutes.

Book Your Free Discovery Call

Have questions first? Email us at info@theapplicationlab.com

Website: www.theapplicationlab.com

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/company/theapplicationlab

Instagram: instagram.com/theapplicationlab

YouTube: youtube.com/@TheApplicationLab